

and ability to bowl into the pitch made him a force to reckon with.

Andre Russell, Chakravarthy, and Sunil Narine combined to make KKR the tournament's most economical side in the middle overs with the best average (20.17). KKR was the only side to have six bowlers in the squad who picked 10 or more wickets in the season, three of whom were Rana, Arora, and Chakravarthy.

On the batting front, the Iyers (Shreyas and Venkatesh) and the Singhs (Rinku and Ramandeep) chipped in with handy contributions to prop up the blazing starts provided by overseas openers Narine and Phil Salt. Though not many fancied KKR's chances, it had all its bases covered, largely thanks to an unfancied Indian core and an in-form overseas unit.

Behind the scenes, the backroom staff comprising mentor Gautam Gambhir, head coach Chandrakant Pandit, and assistant coach Abhishek Nayar embodied the value of experience, grooming domestic talent, and being acquainted with the ethos of a franchise. After guiding KKR as captain to two title triumphs in 2012 and 2014, Gambhir returned to the franchise with an uncompromising winning mentality.

"Gautam bhai has immense knowledge about how the game is played. He has won two titles with KKR, and his strategies have been spot-on. He adds a lot of cream to the team," captain Iyer had said ahead of the final.

Meanwhile, Pandit's purported disciplinarian approach yielded



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ANDRE RUSSELL, VARUN CHAKRAVARTHY (right, below) AND SUNIL NARINE COMBINED TO MAKE KKR THE TOURNAMENT'S MOST ECONOMICAL SIDE IN THE MIDDLE OVERS